Managing stress and change

Managing stress & change (Children's MH Week).

Aspire · Thursday 14 January 2027 · P4 · Year A

Stress is a response to pressure or change. It can affect the body, thoughts, feelings and actions. Signs differ and can have other causes. A body map cannot diagnose.

Invented learner

An invented learner hears that two familiar tasks will happen in a different order. Their shoulders feel tense, their stomach feels fluttery and it is hard to focus. They think, “I will get every part wrong.” The tasks are familiar and school staff can explain the first step. Nothing unsafe has happened.

Story body map or list

Link the three story clues to the map or a list. Explain why another cause is possible and why a class map is not a diagnosis. Do not suggest a diagnosis or ask about anyone’s symptoms.

Three safe trials

Use Support Cards page 2. Breathing: easy own-pace breaths, no holds or forced depth. Reframing: check the invented thought against known facts. Movement: one small familiar move suited to access/health plans. For each, try, adapt, observe or pass. Stop if uncomfortable. No personal feeling report is needed.

Lesson resource · CC BY-NC-SA 4.0: free for classroom use, share and adapt with credit, no resale

A fairer thought and a safe choice

Compare two safe strategies for the invented change, then choose one. Explain a limit or practical barrier and adapt the choice. Keep the fairer thought tied to known facts and real support. More personal detail or writing is not required.

Model: “The order changed. I know some parts. I can ask for the first step.” School staff could explain the plan. Reframing does not mean ignoring a real problem.

Use the private plan card if you wish. Keep it with you; fictional, blank or pass is valid. Do not add names, symptoms, a private worry or health/family details.

Learning self check

All boxes start blank. This checks learning, not feelings, symptoms or whether a strategy worked. Observing, adapting or passing is recorded fairly, without a health judgement.

Learning today	Choose if useful
I can explain stress and a possible sign without diagnosing.	Ready to explain [ ] With a prompt [ ] Need another example [ ]
I can describe the three strategies and a safe choice or adaptation.	Ready to explain [ ] With a prompt [ ] Need another example [ ]
I can show a fairer thought and a route to support.	Ready to explain [ ] With a prompt [ ] Need another example [ ]

Keep the short fictional work from practice. Use one adult next step and reply in the same colour, on the same page or usual mode. Ask trusted school staff privately for help; the agreed supervised pause route stays available.

Lesson resource · CC BY-NC-SA 4.0: free for classroom use, share and adapt with credit, no resale